Radiation Protection Field Guide

Lakeside Research Reactor · Health Physics Office · Edition 3

About this guide

This guide summarises the practical rules for working safely in areas where radiation exposure is possible. It is written for staff, students, and contractors, and does not replace the facility radiation protection programme.

If you are unsure whether a rule applies to you, ask the duty health physicist before entering a designated area.

1. Designated areas

The facility has supervised areas and controlled areas. Controlled areas are marked with yellow signage at every entrance and require specific training, dosimetry, and authorisation before entry.

2. Training before entry

Before entering a controlled area for the first time, staff must complete the eight hour initial radiation safety course and pass its written assessment with a score of at least 80 percent. The qualification remains valid only while an annual refresher is completed.

Training records are held by the Health Physics Office. Supervisors should confirm that a worker's training is current before assigning work in a controlled area.

3. Dosimetry

A personal dosimeter must be issued and logged at the access point before each entry into a controlled area. The dosimeter is worn on the chest, outside clothing, and returned at the same access point on exit.

Lost or damaged dosimeters must be reported before the end of the shift so that a dose assessment can be made.

4. Visitors

Visitors who have not completed the initial course may enter a controlled area only when escorted at all times by qualified staff and after receiving a safety briefing at the access point.

5. Contamination control

Hands and feet are monitored on leaving a controlled area. If the monitor alarms, stay at the monitor, do not touch other surfaces, and call the duty health physicist.

6. Dose limits

The facility sets an administrative dose limit below the regulatory limit to provide a margin of safety. Workers approaching the administrative limit are reassigned to work that does not involve exposure.

7. Emergencies

In an emergency, follow the instructions of the emergency coordinator. Leave the controlled area by the nearest marked exit and report to the assembly point. Do not return for personal items.

Practice drills are announced in advance. Unannounced drills may also be held at the discretion of the facility manager.